

“By the Crib Wherein Reposing” Text: <i>Stabat Mater Speciosa</i>, Jacobus de Benedictis, d. 1306; tr. Denis Florence MacCarthy, d. 1882 Tune: STABAT MATER, <i>Gesangbuch</i>, Mainz, 1661	“At the Cross Her Station Keeping” Text: <i>Stabat Mater Dolorosa</i>, Jacobus de Benedictis, d. 1306; tr. Edward Caswall, 1849 Tune: STABAT MATER, <i>Gesangbuch</i>, Mainz, 1661
1. By the crib wherein reposing, with His eyes in slumber closing, lay serene her infant boy. 2. Stood the beauteous mother feeling bliss that could not bear concealing, so her face o’erflowed with joy.	1. At the cross, her station keeping, stood the mournful mother weeping, close to Jesus to the last. 2. Through her heart, His sorrow sharing, all His bitter anguish bearing, now at length the sword has passed.
3. Oh, the rapture naught could smother of that most immaculate mother of the sole-begotten one. 4. When with laughing heart exulting, she beheld her hopes resulting in the great birth of her son.	3. O how sad and sore distressed was that mother, highly blest, of the sole-begotten one. 4. Christ above in torment hangs, she beneath beholds the pangs of her dying, glorious son.
5. Who would not with gratulation see the happy consolation of Christ’s mother undefiled? 6. Who would not be glad surveying Christ’s dear mother bending, praying, playing with her heav’nly child?	5. Is there one who would not weep, whelmed in miseries so deep, Christ’s dear mother to behold? 6. Can the human heart refrain from partaking in her pain, in that mother’s pain untold?
7. O’er that lowly manger winging, joyful hosts from heav’n were singing canticles of holy praise. 8. While the old man and the maiden, speaking naught, with hearts o’erladen, pondered on God’s wondrous ways.	7. Bruised, derided, cursed, defiled, she beheld her tender child all with bloody scourges rent. 8. For the sins of His own nation, saw Him hang in desolation, till His spirit forth He sent.
9. Fount of love, forever flowing, with a burning ardor glowing, make me, mother, feel like thee. 10. Let my heart, with graces gifted all on fire, to Christ be lifted, and by Him accepted be.	9. O thou mother! Fount of love! Touch my spirit from above, make my heart with thine accord. 10. Make me feel as thou hast felt; make my soul to glow and melt with the love of Christ, my Lord.

11. Holy mother, deign to bless me, with His sacred wounds impress me, let them in my heart abide. 12. Since He came, thy son, the holy, to a birth-place, ah, so lowly, all His pains with me divide.	11. Holy mother! Pierce me through, in my heart each wound renew of my savior crucified. 12. Let me share with thee His pain who for all my sins was slain, who for me in torments died.
13. Make me with true joy delighted, to child Jesus be united while my days of life endure; 14. While in exile here sojourning, make my heart like thine be burning with a love divine and pure.	13. Let me mingle tears with thee, mourning Him who mourned for me, all the days that I may live. 14. By the cross with thee to stay, there with thee to weep and pray, all I ask of thee to give.
15. Virgin of all virgins highest, pray'r to thee thou ne'er denyest, let me bear thy sweet child too.	15. Virgin of all virgins blest, listen to my fond request: let me share thy grief divine.
16. Let me bear Him in my bosom, Lord of life, and never lose Him, since His birth doth death subdue.	16. Let me, to my latest breath, in my body bear the death of that dying son of thine.
17. All who in the crib revere Him, like the shepherds watching near Him, will attend Him through the night. 18. By thy pow'rful prayers protected, grant, O queen, that His elected may behold heav'n's moving light.	17. Wounded with His every wound, steep my soul till it hath swooned, in His very blood away. 18. Be to me, O virgin, nigh, lest in flames I burn and die in His awful judgment day.
19. Make me by His birth be guarded, by God's holy Word be warded, by His grace 'till all is done. 20. When my body lies obstructed, make my soul to be conducted, to the vision of thy son.	19. Christ, when Thou shalt call me hence, by Thy mother, my defense, by Thy cross, my victory. 20. While my body here decays, may my soul Thy goodness praise, safe in paradise with Thee.